

NYC RESTAURANT INSPECTIONS



An Analysis of Critical Health Violations (2016–2026)

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PROBLEM STATEMENT

Between 2016 and 2026, inspection records from the New York City Department of Health and Mental Hygiene (DOHMH) show that 52% of restaurant inspections result in at least one Critical Violation — posing a direct risk of foodborne illness to the public. However, it remains unclear which violation types drive this risk most, whether certain cuisines are more prone to critical violations, and whether these risks fluctuate throughout the year. Understanding these patterns is essential for DOHMH to prioritize inspection resources more effectively.

OBJECTIVES



- Top 10 Most Common Health Violations
- Inspection Scores: Critical vs Non-Critical
- Critical Violations by Borough
- Critical vs. Non-Critical Violations by Cuisine
- Critical Violation Trend (2017–2025)
- Critical Violations by Month
- Top 10 Brands: Score Change (2022–2025)



DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND MENTAL HYGIENE

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- The NYC DOHMH is the official government agency legally responsible for enforcing food safety and protecting public health across the city.
- The department conducts strict, unannounced field inspections of all restaurants to ensure compliance with sanitary codes and prevent foodborne illnesses.
- Inspectors evaluate kitchen operations, food handling, and hygiene, converting every observed failure into sanitary penalty points.
- The accumulated points—where fewer points mean a cleaner kitchen—directly determine the restaurant's public health grade:
 - Grade A : 0 – 13 pts
 - Grade B : 14 – 27 pts
 - Grade C : 28+ pts



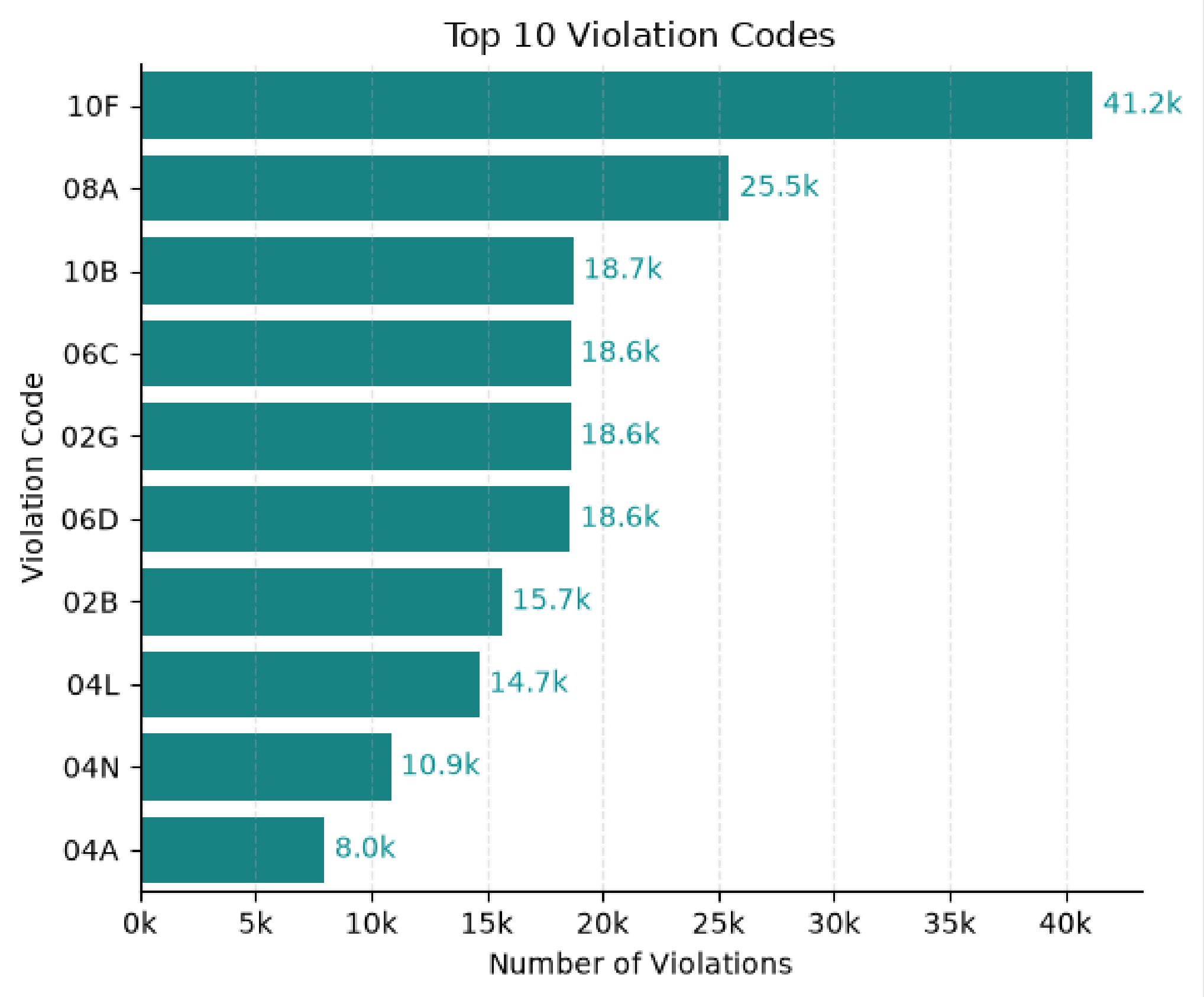
TOP 10 MOST COMMON HEALTH VIOLATIONS



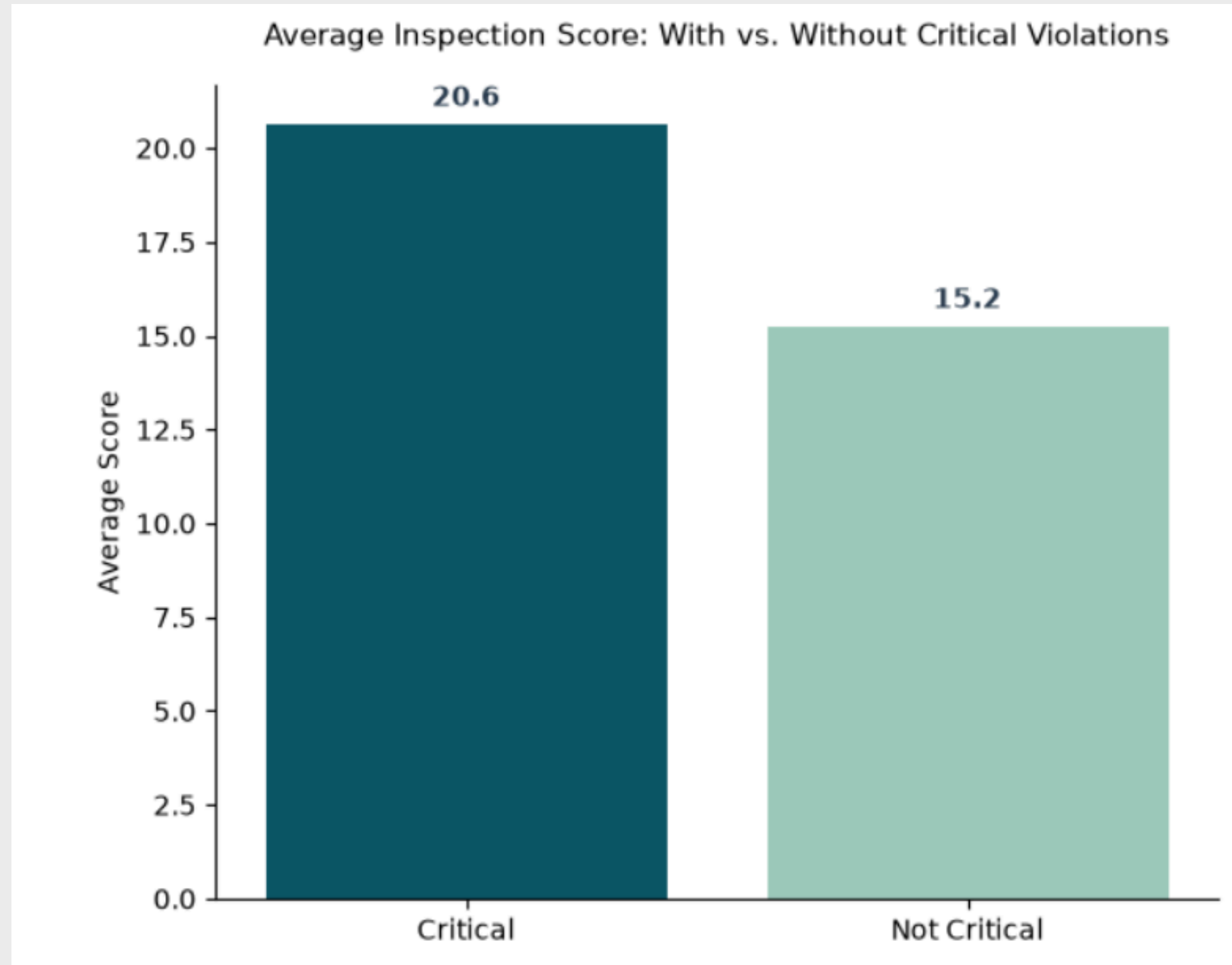
Code 10F — Non-Food
Contact Surfaces

Code 08A — Vermin & Pest
Prevention

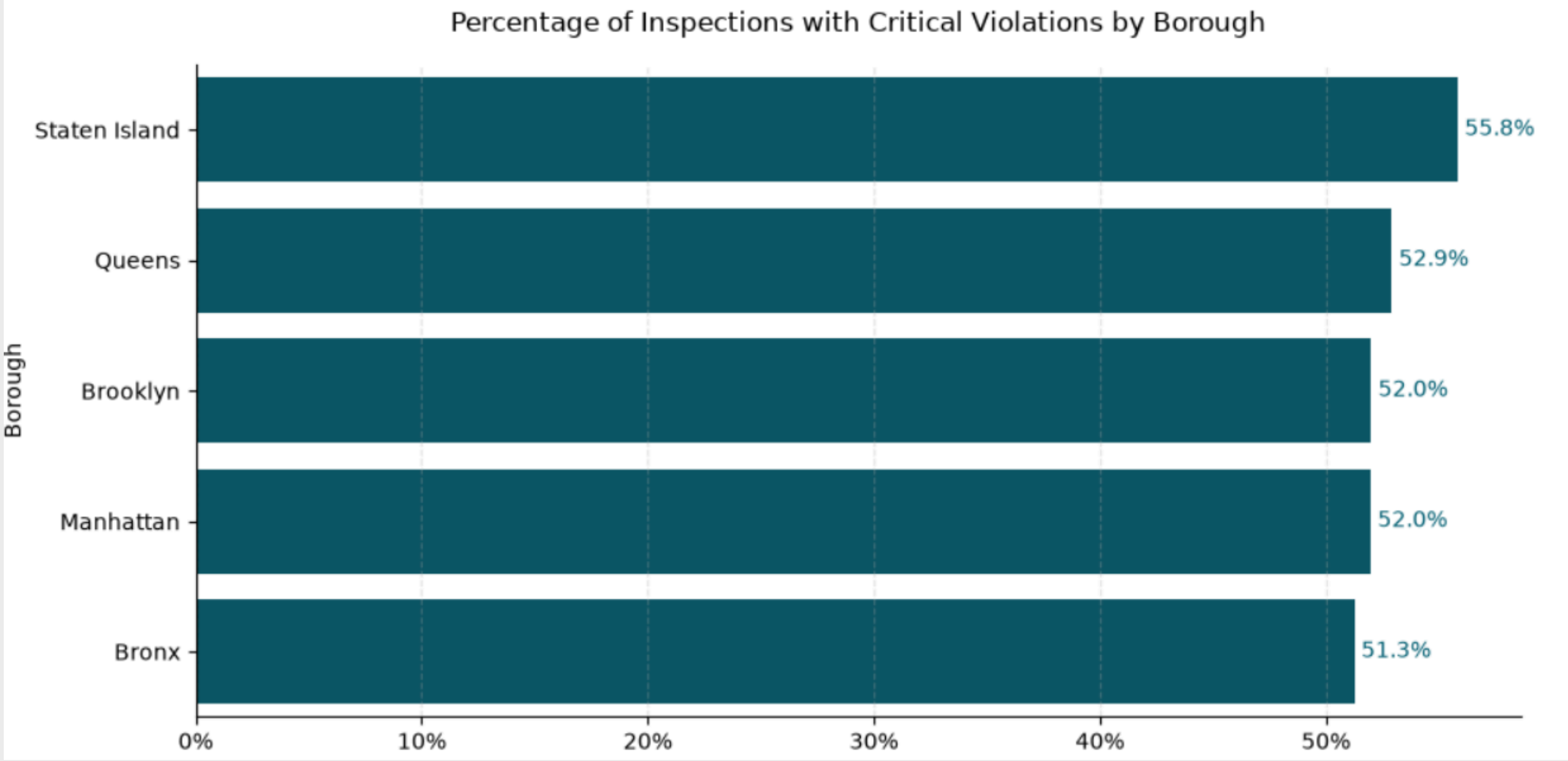
Code 10B — Utensil &
Equipment Sanitization



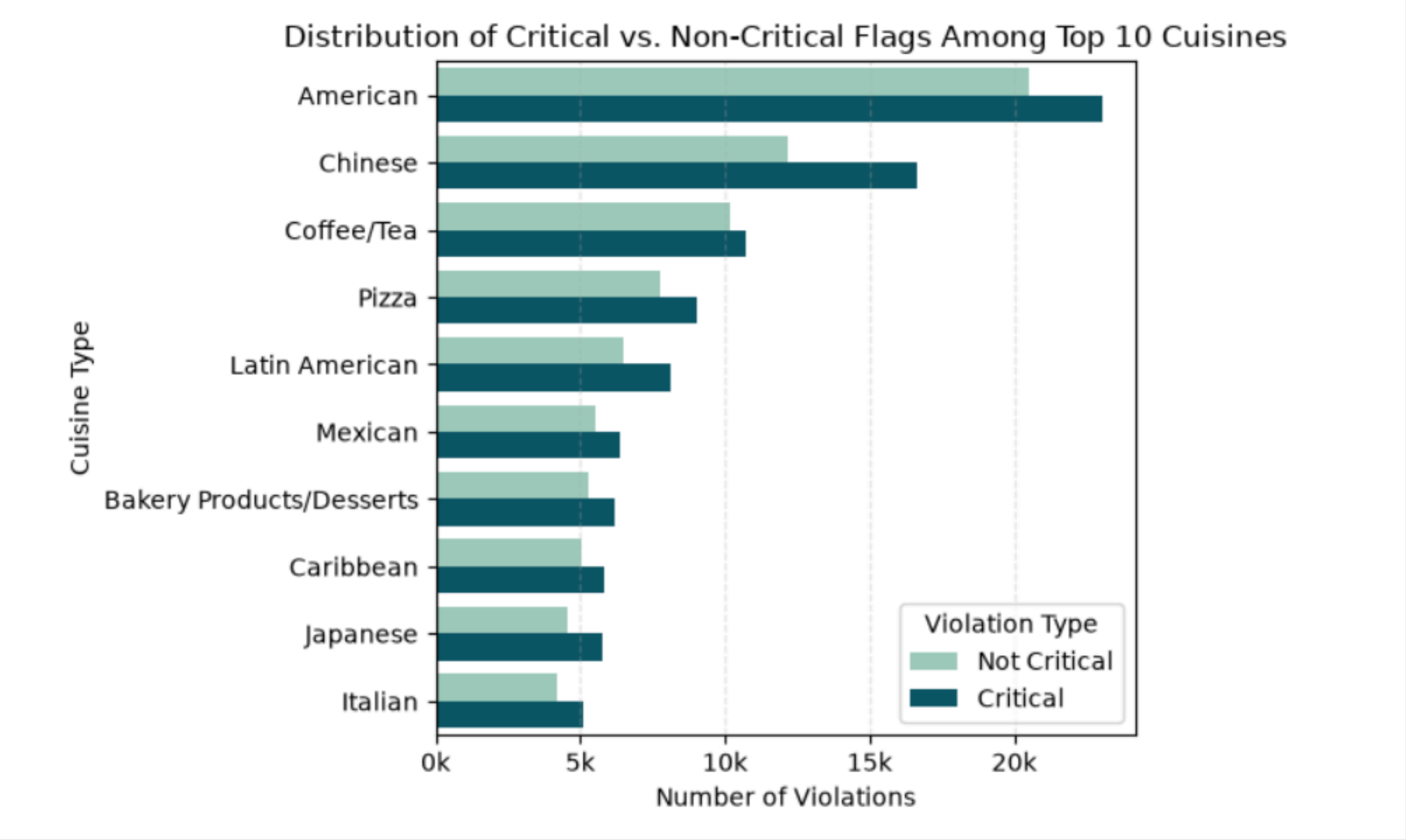
INSPECTION SCORES: CRITICAL VS NON-CRITICAL



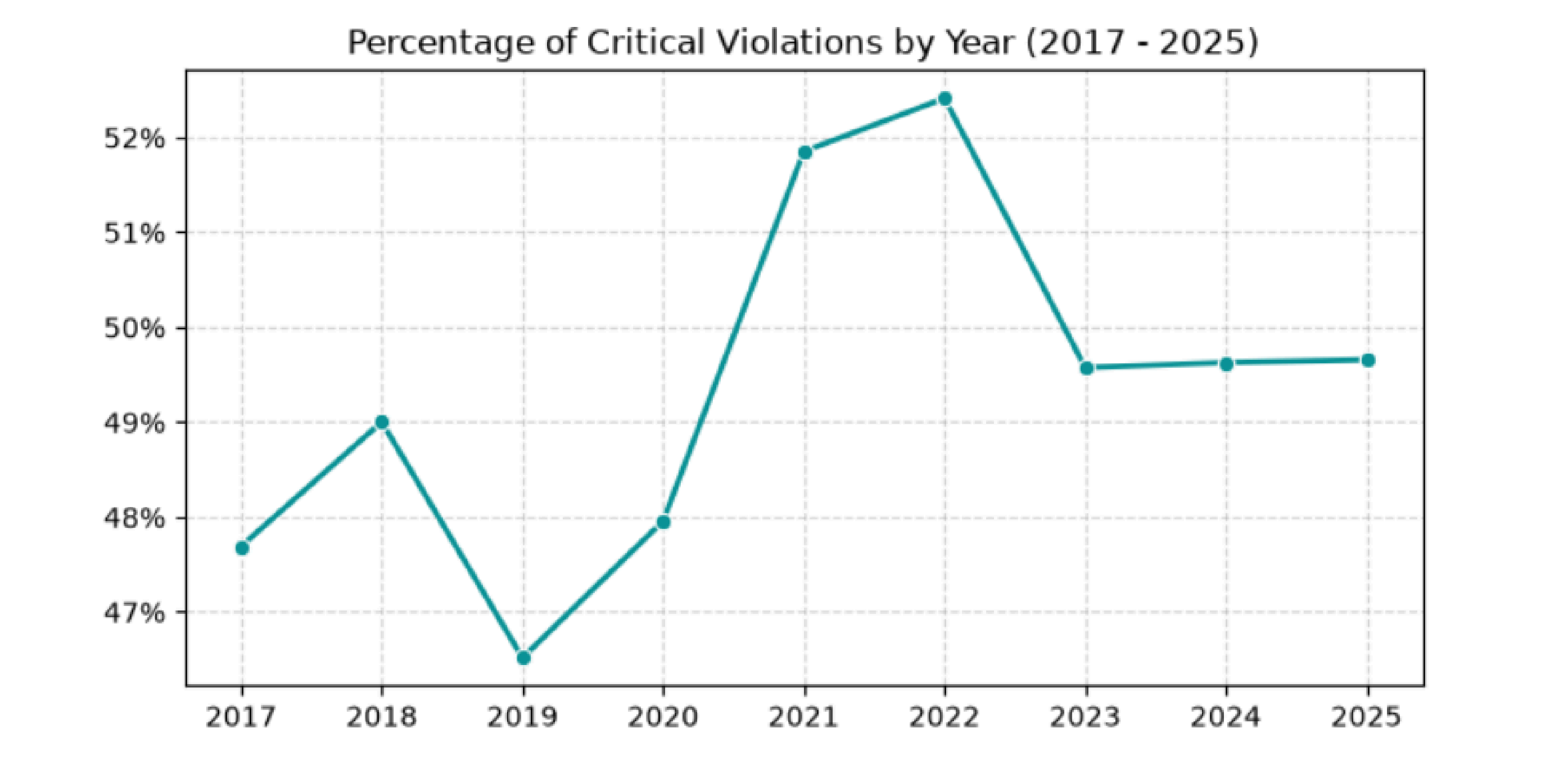
CRITICAL VIOLATIONS BY BOROUGH



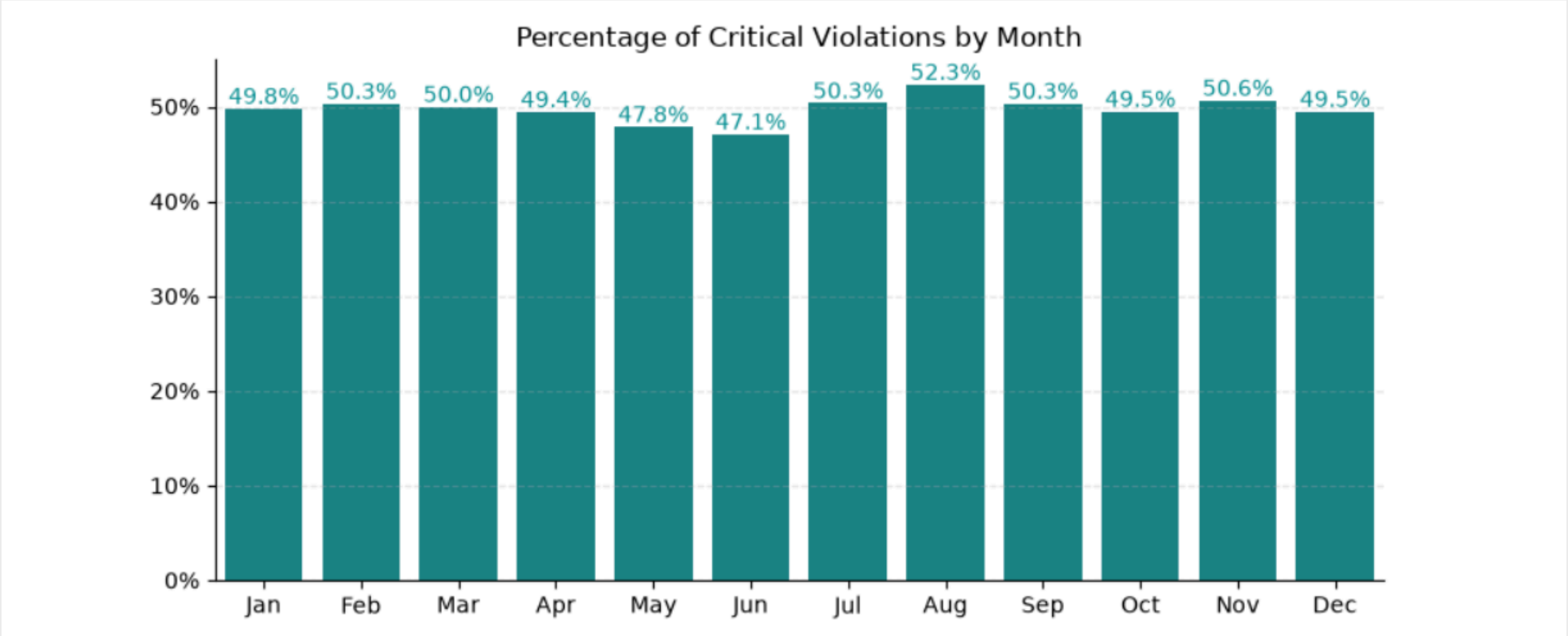
CRITICAL VS NON-CRITICAL VIOLATIONS BY CUISINE



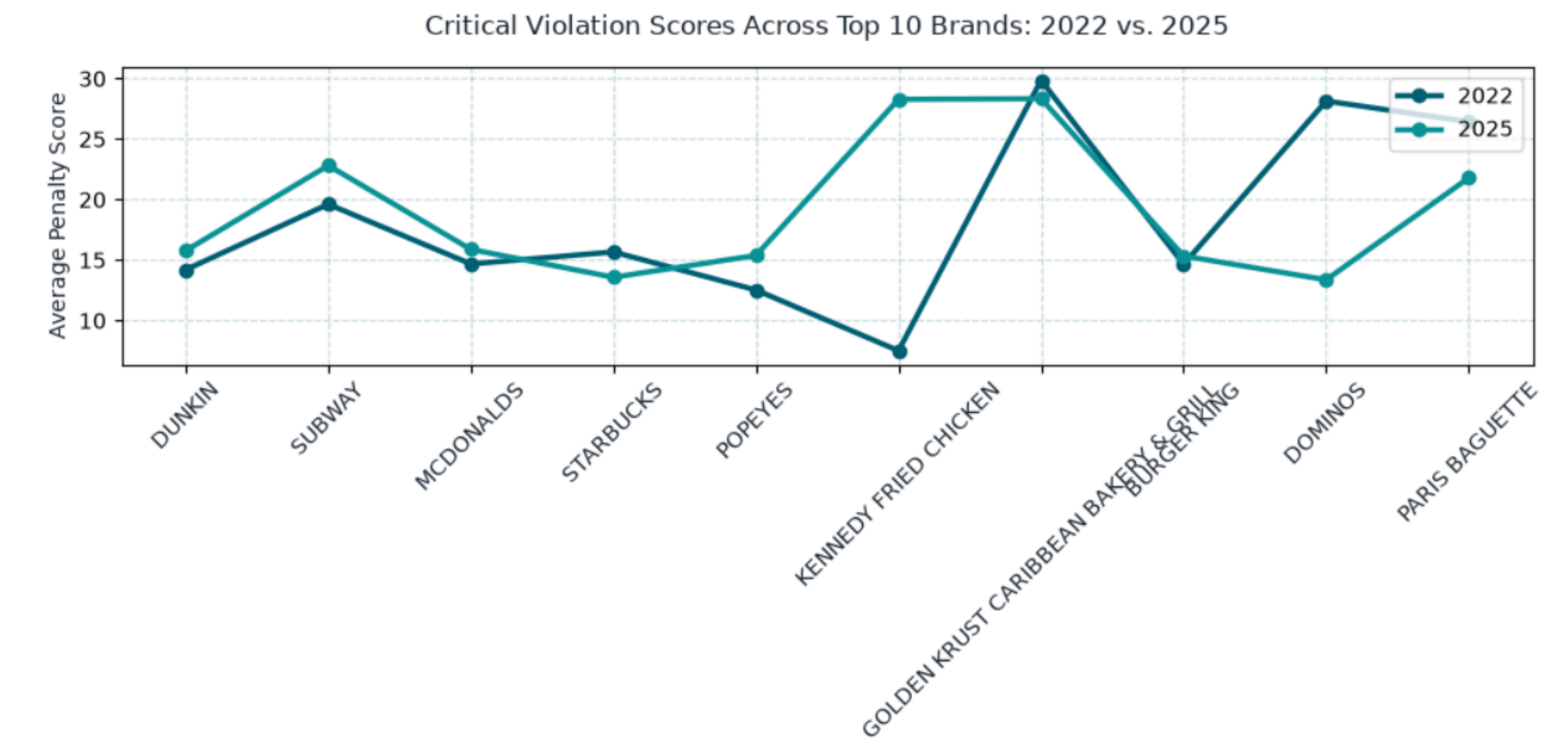
CRITICAL VIOLATION TREND (2017-2025)



CRITICAL VIOLATIONS BY MONTH



TOP 10 BRANDS: SCORE CHANGE (2022-2025)



RECOMMENDATIONS



- **Focus on the top 3 violation types (10F, 08A, 10B):** they make up the bulk of all violations, so targeted training here goes further than blanket inspections.
- **Treat this as a citywide problem:** not a borough problem. Critical violation rates only vary by 4.5 points across boroughs (51.3%–55.8%).
- **Keep a closer eye on chains like Kennedy Fried Chicken and Golden Krust:** Their scores are high, and some are getting worse — checking one location at a time isn't catching the full problem.
- **Figure out what changed around 2023:** that brought violation rates down from a 2022 peak (52.4%) to a stable ~49.6% — and double down on it.

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**THANK
YOU**